

Meoncross School History Department

YEAR 8 SCHEME OF WORK (2026-2027)

Curriculum Planning & Lesson Companion

Key Stage 3 Curriculum Intent & Pedagogical Architecture

1. Curriculum Rationale & Local Maritime Heritage

Our Key Stage 3 history curriculum is intentionally constructed to link national and global historical narratives with the distinctive maritime geography and lived environment of Meoncross pupils. From the industrial revolution of the Fareham ironmaster (Henry Cort at Funtley) to the strategic supremacy of Portsmouth Royal Dockyard and the profound sacrifices recorded on the Stubbington village war memorials, history is made tangible, relevant, and deeply rooted in our coastal community.

2. Disciplinary Progression & Historical Enquiry

Across Years 7, 8, and 9, disciplinary thinking progresses sequentially to secure the foundational skills required for GCSE excellence:

- **Chronological Rigour & Global Encounters:** De-centering traditional anglocentric narratives by examining early global trade, Indigenous perspectives in Australia, and African resistance to the Transatlantic Slave Trade alongside British social transformations.
- **Causation & Consequence:** Moving from simple direct triggers in Year 7 to evaluating multi-tiered, long-term geopolitical catalysts (e.g. European alliance systems, naval arms races).
- **Source Utility & Forensic Evidence:** Progressing from basic comprehension to rigorous interrogation of provenance, evaluating authorial motive, audience, and historical reliability.
- **Historiographical Debate:** Engaging pupils with active academic debates (e.g., assessing the Magna Carta, or challenging the 'Lions led by Donkeys' narrative of the Great War) grounded in historical evidence.

3. Adaptive Teaching, Dual Coding & Inclusion

Pupils work through bespoke printed A4 workbooks closely paired with our digital learning portal. Standardized PEE/PEEL Structure Strips, Causal Connective Banks, consistent dual coding, and digital accessibility features offload working memory, ensuring all SEND and lower-attaining pupils achieve ambitious historical progress with zero cognitive overload.

KS3: Early Modern World & Global Encounters (1450–1750)

Year 8 | How 'global' was Britain's transformation between 1450 and 1750?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 Who held global power in 1450?	• Identify the major global powers and trading hubs in the year 1450. • Explain how the Ottoman Empire and West African kingdoms controlled global wealth. • Evaluate why Western Europe was on the periphery (edges) of world trade in 1450.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: 15th-century manuscript illumination of English peasants working the land; Source B: Eyewitness Diary of Nicolò Barbaro (May 1453); Detail of Mansa Musa from the Catalan Atlas (1375)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate why Western Europe was on the periphery (edges) of world trade in 1450.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Explain why Europe was not the centre of global wealth and power in 1450.

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 2 How did religious conflict trigger global exploration (1517–1588)?	- Explain how the Protestant Reformation shattered European unity after 1517. - Analyze the role of Elizabethan privateers in challenging Catholic Spain's global monopoly. - Evaluate how the Spanish Armada (1588) marked a turning point in Britain's imperial ambitions.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Map of the Treaty of Tordesillas (1494); Portrait of Sir Francis Drake (1591) by Marcus Gheeraerts the Younger; Expedition Map of the Route of the Spanish Armada (1588) by Robert Adams  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate how the defeat of the Spanish Armada (1588) marked a turning point in Britain's imperial ambitions.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Explain how religious conflict between Catholics and Protestants pushed England into global exploration and naval rivalry with Spain between 1517 and 1588.
Lesson 3 Trade or takeover: How did early encounters turn into empire?	- Explain how joint-stock corporations (like the East India Company and Virginia Company) funded early English expansion. - Compare the early English colonial encounters in North America (Roanoke and Jamestown) with mercantile trade in Mughal India. - Evaluate the turning point where peaceful commercial trade shifted into territorial takeover and subjugation.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Engraving of Matoaka (Pocahontas) in Jacobean dress (1616) by Simon van de Passe; Architectural Sketch of James Fort in Virginia (1608) from the Zúñiga Map; Mughal Miniature of Emperor Jahangir (c. 1615–1620)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the turning point where peaceful commercial trade shifted into territorial takeover and empire.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Explain why early English global encounters between 1600 and 1750 shifted from peaceful mercantile trade into armed takeover and empire.
Lesson 4 James I and the Gunpowder Plot: Why was religious division so volatile?	- Explain how the Elizabethan legacy and King James I's broken promises heightened Catholic desperation by 1604. - Analyse the conspiracy hatched by Robert Catesby and Guy Fawkes beneath Parliament and evaluate the discovery through the Montague Letter. - Evaluate competing historical interpretations regarding whether Robert Cecil discovered or manufactured the conspiracy.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Portrait of King James I (c. 1606) by John de Critz; The Gunpowder Plot Conspirators (1605) by Crispin van de Passe the Elder; Transcript: The Anonymous Warning Letter to Lord Montague (26 October 1605)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Analyse the conspiracy hatched by Robert Catesby and Guy Fawkes beneath Parliament and evaluate the discovery through the Montague Letter.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: How far do you agree with Interpretation 1 that the Gunpowder Plot was a genuine, independently hatched Catholic conspiracy, rather than an entrapment scheme orchestrated or manipulated b...
Lesson 5 Who controlled Britain? The Ideological Battle	- Explain how Charles I's belief in the Divine Right of Kings and eleven years of Personal Rule provoked civil war with Parliament. - Analyse how the creation of the New Model Army transformed the war and led to the unprecedented trial of the King for high treason. - Evaluate the revolutionary consequences of the Regicide and the establishment of the English Commonwealth.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Triple Portrait of King Charles I by Anthony van Dyck (1635); Source C: Death Warrant of King Charles I (29 January 1649); Contemporary German print of the Execution of King Charles I (1649)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the revolutionary consequences of the Regicide and the establishment of the English Commonwealth.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Explain two consequences of the trial and public execution of King Charles I in January 1649. [8 marks]
Lesson 6 Who controlled Britain? The Economic Shift	- Explain how Oliver Cromwell's Navigation Acts (1651) established a state policy of mercantilism and challenged Dutch naval hegemony. - Analyse how the founding of the Bank of England (1694) and the National Debt created a powerful Fiscal-Military State. - Evaluate the extent of economic change and continuity in Britain's domestic wealth and global colonial exploitation by 1720.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: The Great Seal of the Commonwealth of England (1651); Courtyard of the Royal Exchange, London (Late 17th Century); Source C: Royal Charter of the Governor and Company of the Bank of England (27 July 1694)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the extent of economic change and continuity in Britain's domestic wealth and global colonial exploitation by 1720.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Explain why Britain underwent a financial and commercial revolution between 1651 and 1720. [12 marks]

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 7 What were the mechanics of the Transatlantic Slave Trade?	- Explain the three stages of the Triangular Trade and analyse how British manufactured commodities fueled human trafficking on the West African coast. - Analyse the physical and psychological brutality of the Middle Passage using forensic primary evidence from the Brookes slave ship diagram. - Evaluate the utility of contemporary sources and plantation records for investigating the dehumanisation and industrial exploitation of enslaved people in the Caribbean.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: The Brookes Slave Ship Diagram (1788); Source C: Eyewitness Account of a Kingston Slave Scramble (c. 1770s)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the utility of contemporary sources and plantation records for investigating the dehumanisation and industrial exploitation of enslaved people in the Caribbean.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: How useful are Source B (The Brookes Slave Ship Diagram) and Source D (The Antigua Sugar Plantation Engraving) for an enquiry into the brutal mechanics of the Transatlantic Slave Trade? [...]
Lesson 8 How did enslaved Africans resist the Transatlantic Slave Trade?	- Analyse the "spectrum of resistance" and explain how covert defiance, cultural preservation, and work slowdowns enabled enslaved people to maintain their humanity. - Evaluate the military significance of Queen Nanny and the Jamaican Maroons, who forced the British Empire into signing peace treaties in 1739. - Assess the historical agency of Black abolitionists, focusing on Olaudah Equiano and the Sons of Africa, in shifting British public opinion against the slave trade.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Diary of Jamaican Overseer Thomas Thistlewood (Excerpts, 1750–1760); Maroons in Ambush on the Island of Jamaica (18th Century Engraving)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the military significance of Queen Nanny and the Jamaican Maroons, who forced the British Empire into signing peace treaties in 1739.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Explain the significance of enslaved resistance (both covert defiance and Maroon guerrilla warfare) in challenging the British plantation complex before 1750. [12 marks]
Lesson 9 How 'modern' was Britain by 1750? (Synthesis & Assessment)	- Synthesise political transformations from absolute divine monarchy to constitutional parliamentary oligarchy following the 1689 Bill of Rights. - Contrast the extraordinary imperial, mercantile, and financial power of London with acute domestic poverty, the Bloody Code, and the Gin Craze. - Formulate a sustained, nuanced historical judgement evaluating whether Britain by 1750 can genuinely be characterized as "modern".	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Bill of Rights (1689, Key Clauses); Allegory of Britannia receiving the riches of the East Indies (18th Century)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Contrast the extraordinary imperial, mercantile, and financial power of London with acute domestic poverty, the Bloody Code, and the Gin Craze.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: 'By 1750, Britain had become an enlightened, modern global superpower.' How far do you agree with this statement? [16 marks + 4 SPaG]

KS3: Industrialisation, Empire, and Power (1750–1900)

Year 8 | Industrialisation, Empire, and Power: How did 19th-century Britain transform at home and abroad?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 What powered the Industrial Revolution, and how did a Fareham ironmaster change the world?	- Understand the difference between the domestic system and the factory system. - Explain the significance of Henry Cort's puddling and rolling processes. - Evaluate the importance of location versus innovation in Cort's success.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Cort's Patent Specification No. 1420 (1784); Source B: Contemporary Dedication Portrait of Henry Cort (c. 1780s); Source C: Admiralty Navy Board Portsmouth Dockyard Trial Minutes (1787)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the importance of location versus innovation in Cort's success.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [2 Marks] Describe one feature of the domestic system. • [2 Marks] Describe one feature of Henry Cort's puddling process.

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 2 Was industrial work progress or punishment?	- Understand the working conditions of the early Industrial Revolution with historical nuance. - Evaluate primary sources regarding child labour. - Analyse the 'Optimist vs. Pessimist' historical debate.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Powerloom Weaving in 1835  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate primary sources regarding child labour.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [8 Marks] Explain why child labour was so prevalent during the early Industrial Revolution.
Lesson 3 Did industrialisation make British towns unlivable?	- Analyse the contrast between imperial wealth and working-class squalor. - Evaluate the usefulness of contrasting primary sources. - Understand the catalysts for public health reform.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Visual Hook: Over London by Rail (1872); Source B: The Unregulated Capitalism / Corporate Perspective; Source A: The Official, Top-Down Government Data  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Analyse the contrast between imperial wealth and working-class squalor.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 4 How was the British Empire built and sustained?	- Describe how the British Empire expanded through trade, military conquest, and colonisation across Asia and Africa - Explain how religious missions, economic exploitation, and resistance shaped the experience of empire for colonised peoples - Evaluate the significance of the British Empire in transforming global trade networks	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: HMS Warrior at Portsmouth; Walter Crane's Imperial Federation Map (1886); Source A: The Corporate Directive  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate how domestic industrial complexes sustained global naval supremacy.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Synthesis Assessment (8 Marks): 'The British Empire was built and sustained by technological progress rather than violence and exploitation.' To what extent do you agree wi...
Lesson 5 How did the Empire strike back? The 1857 Indian Rebellion	- Describe the causes and events of the Indian Rebellion of 1857 and the forms of resistance used by Indian soldiers - Explain how the rebellion challenged British imperial power and led to direct Crown rule over India - Evaluate the significance of the Indian Rebellion as an example of colonial resistance to empire	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Indian Rebel Manifesto; Source B: The British Military Reprisal  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Core Disciplinary Concept: Historical Enquiry & Causal Argumentation  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 6 How did ordinary people fight for a voice?	- Describe the key protest movements of the 19th century, including Chartism and trade unionism - Explain how industrialisation created new forms of resistance and demands for democracy and parliamentary reform - Evaluate the significance of working-class protest in expanding the power of Parliament and moving towards democracy	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: The Chartist Mass Demonstration at Kennington Common, 1848; Source A: The Threat of Captain Swing; Source B: The Demands of the Chartist Leader  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate how the Chartist movement shifted working-class strategy toward constitutional reform.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Synthesis Assessment (8 Marks): 'The violent machine-breaking of the Swing Riots posed a far greater threat to the British establishment than the political campaigning of t...

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 7 How did the road to democracy expand?	- Describe the key reforms that expanded democracy in 19th-century Britain, including the Reform Acts - Explain how protest, resistance, and propaganda drove the gradual extension of the right to vote - Evaluate the significance of the suffrage movement in transforming British democracy by 1900	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: The First Secret Ballot, 1872; Parliamentary Representation Map of England & Wales (1832); The Old Rotten Tree  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate primary sources to uncover political motives.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Synthesis Assessment: To what extent was Britain a fully functioning democracy by the end of 1884? Use evidence from across the lesson to support your judgment.
Lesson 8 Who truly benefited from 19th-century transformation?	- Synthesise knowledge of industrialisation, empire, trade, democracy, and resistance across the 19th century - Construct a sustained argument evaluating who truly benefited from Britain's transformation - Deploy specific evidence about power, colonialism, and urbanisation to support a historical judgement	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Capital and Labour: The Two Faces of Victorian Britain  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Synthesize unit-wide knowledge to evaluate historical progress versus exploitation.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Capstone Essay (16 Marks): 'The transformation of 19th-century Britain was a triumph of progress that benefited the entire nation.' To what extent do you agree with this in...

Unit Key Vocabulary: Industrial Revolution • Industrialisation • Domestic System • Factory System • Puddling Process • Wrought Iron • Steam Power • Urbanisation • Slum • Back-to-Back Housing • Public Health • Cholera • Miasma Theory • Laissez-faire • Child Labour • Factory Acts • Trade Union • Captain Swing • Swing Riots • Chartism • People's Charter • Universal Suffrage • Franchise • Rotten Borough • Pocket Borough • Great Reform Act (1832) • Secret Ballot Act (1872) • Empire • Colonialism • Imperialism • East India Company • Sepoy • Indian Rebellion (1857) • British Raj • Ironclad • Two-Power Standard • Historiography • Optimist View • Pessimist View • Synthesis

KS3: History of Australia

Year 8 | Invasion, Settlement, or Survival? How should we remember the colonization of Australia?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 Claiming Australia	- Describe how and why the British Empire claimed Australia, including Captain Cook's voyage and the concept of terra nullius - Explain the significance of colonisation for both the British Empire and the Indigenous Australian peoples - Evaluate whether the British arrival should be understood as discovery, settlement, or invasion	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Secret Instructions to Captain Cook; Source B: A Portrait of Captain James Cook; Source C: Initial Encounter at Botany Bay  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Explain the dual purpose of James Cook's voyage, contrasting the public scientific mission with the secret government orders to claim territory.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 2 Creating a Convict Colony	- Describe the key features of the convict transportation system and explain why Britain used Australia as a penal colony - Explain how the British Empire used convict labour to establish a colonial foothold in the Pacific - Evaluate the human cost of the convict system and its role in the revolution of Australian settlement	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Prison Hulks in Portsmouth Harbour  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Analyse the work and social conditions of the convicts, contrasting general labor with the punishments of the chain road gangs.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 3 Encounters with the Indigenous Peoples	- Describe the impact of British colonisation on Indigenous Australian communities, including the destruction of trade, culture, and land - Explain how Indigenous Australians showed resistance to British settlement through both armed conflict and cultural survival - Evaluate the significance of these encounters for understanding the long-term consequences of empire	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Bennelong's Letter to England; Early Settlement at Sydney Cove  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Core Disciplinary Concept: Historical Enquiry & Causal Argumentation  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 4 From Penal Colony to Settlement	- Describe how Australia transitioned from a penal colony to a free settlement through migration and the Gold Rush - Explain how empire, revolution, and change shaped the development of Australian society in the 19th century - Evaluate who benefited most from Australia's transformation and who was marginalised	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: William Barak's Testimony; The Australian Gold Rush  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Core Disciplinary Concept: Historical Enquiry & Causal Argumentation  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 5 Lesson 5: Assessment - What's the story of Australia?	- Synthesise knowledge of colonisation, empire, resistance, and change across the history of Australia - Construct a sustained argument evaluating whose perspective should shape how we remember Australia's history - Deploy specific evidence to support a judgement about the legacy of empire in Australia	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Contemporary primary excerpts and archival evidence.  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the usefulness of primary sources for historical enquiries.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Write a narrative account analyzing the development of Australia between the years 1788 and 1855.
Unit Key Vocabulary: Ancestors • Botany Bay • Colony • Gweagal • Navigator • Royal Society • Terra Nullius • First Fleet • Convict • Governor • Hard labour • Hulk • Transportation • Sydney Cove • Eora • Frontier • Guerrilla Warfare • Dispossession • Massacre • Squatter • Merino • Gold Rush • Immigrant • Xenophobia • White Australia Policy		